



Haida and the Tlingit in the west, and the Iroquois, Algonquin, and Cree in the central and eastern regions); the **Métis**, a mixed-race group that originated from unions between French-Canadian fur traders and native

women; and the **Inuit** in the north. All these people have very individual cultures, but they share a strong and growing pride in their indigenous heritage.

WITHOUT FEAR



Since many apparently lack a fear of heights, Iroquois men often work on building sites. Iroquois crews have helped to build such celebrated projects as the Empire State Building, the Golden Gate Bridge, and the world's tallest free-standing structure—the CN Tower in Toronto (left).

Haida life

Unlike many peoples, the Haida have always had rich natural food resources, which encouraged them to trade with other groups. As a result, elaborate social ceremonies—many concerned with skills and status—developed between the various trading groups.

BUTTON BLANKETS

These dancers are wearing ceremonial button blankets, which were once made by sewing shell fragments onto blankets traded from the Europeans. Now, bought buttons and blankets fulfill the same functions.



Headdresses are stylized figures of sea creatures, animals, birds, and mythical beings.



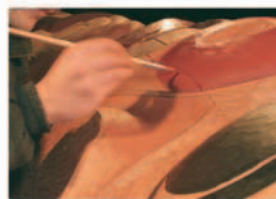
TOTEM POLES

For the native people who make them, totem poles are important cultural and historical documents. They are created to record a family's history, or to mark significant milestones such as the death of a leader.



1 Carving

The animals carved on a totem tend to be mythical figures that represent families or clans. Human figures often portray the pole's owner.



2 Painting

Of all the totem poles made by indigenous Northwestern people, those of the Haida feature the most beautiful and intricate painting.



3 Raising

The heavy poles are hauled upright by large groups of people. They use four sets of ropes in each direction, and a supporting X-frame.

FLOATING TREES

The Haida also carve and paint beautiful dugout canoes, which they once traded to other Pacific-coast peoples. The giant cedars that make the best canoes grow in the Queen Charlotte Islands off British Columbia. The Haida know this territory—their homeland—as *Haida Gwaii*—"islands of the people."

